

GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Vehicles

Emergency Response Guide

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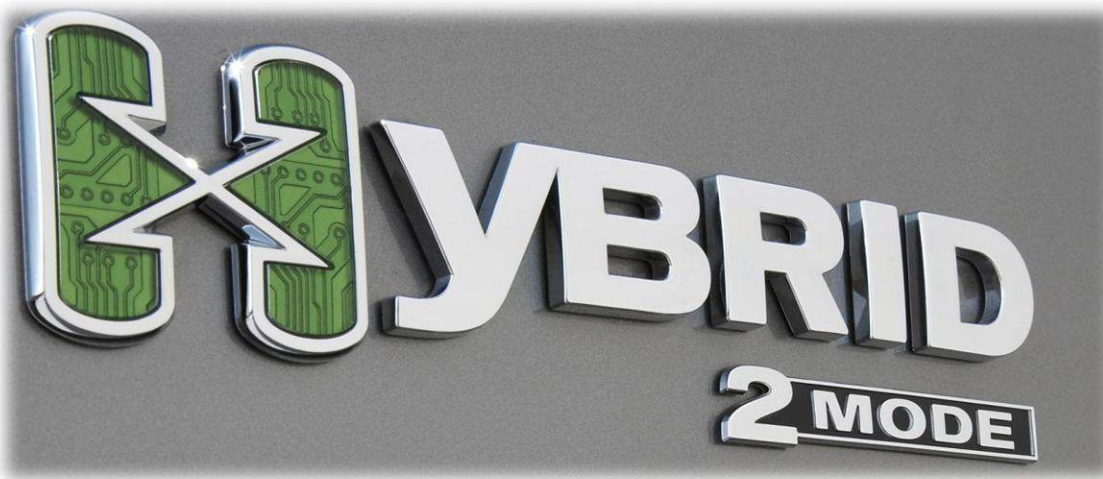
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The intent of this guide is to provide information to help you respond to emergency situations involving the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode vehicles in as safe a manner as possible.

While the majority of the components that make up our Hybrids are common to traditional GM vehicles, there are some differences that may affect how a rescue procedure is performed.

This guide contains a general description of how the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode vehicle systems operate, gives the location of their Hybrid badging, and offers illustrations of their unique components. The guide also describes methods of disabling the system and presents cut zone information.



Vehicle Identification

Special badging is used to identify the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles. One of these emblems is located on the lower right corner of the vehicle's liftgate.



Also the eighth digit of the Vehicle Identification Number (VIN) can also be used to identify a Two-mode Hybrid vehicle. If the eighth digit is a five (5), this signifies the vehicle is a Hybrid.



Vehicle Identification (cont.)

A Hybrid badge is also located on the right and left C-pillars of the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles.



Vehicle Identification (cont.)

A tachometer with Auto Stop indicator and an Economy gauge are unique to the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles.

Tachometer with
Auto Stop Indicator



Economy Gauge

Vehicle Identification (cont.)

When the hood is opened, indications that a Two-mode Hybrid system is present include a Hybrid badge and a HIGH VOLTAGE WARNING label on the power electronics cover.



⚠ WARNING

To help avoid burns or electric shock:

- service by qualified personnel only.
- remove manual disconnect before service.
- do not re-install manual service disconnect until all covers and high voltage cables are in place.

⚡ HIGH VOLTAGE

300V

⚠ AVERTISSEMENT

Pour éviter les brûlures ou les chocs électriques :

- Seul le personnel qualifié est autorisé à effectuer l'entretien.
- Couper l'alimentation avant de procéder à l'entretien.
- S'assurer que tous les couvercles et les câbles haute tension sont en place avant de rétablir l'alimentation.

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Vehicle Identification (cont.)

Under the second row, rear seat sub-floor is a DANGER HIGH VOLTAGE label attached to the Hybrid battery case, indicating high voltage.



System Operation

The GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode vehicles are gasoline-electric Hybrid SUVs/trucks that use up to 25 percent less fuel overall and 40% less fuel in the city, than the non-Hybrid GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade vehicles.

The Hybrid model uses a 300 volt electrical system coupled with a Hybrid transmission and sophisticated technology to achieve its fuel savings.

The vehicle is equipped with a 6.0 liter, Variable Valve Timing (VVT) engine, as well as 300 volt, 42 volt and traditional 12 volt electrical systems.



System Operation (cont.)

During braking and deceleration, energy is recovered and stored in the Two-mode Hybrid battery, this is referred to as Regenerative Braking. Another Hybrid feature is the Auto Stop Mode. The system is designed to shut off the engine at speeds below 25 miles per hour at low throttle angle, or low torque request, when conditions permit.

During vehicle launch the electric motors within the transmission can propel the vehicle to around 25 miles per hour before the engine is restarted. Other conditions that will cause the engine to restart from Auto Stop Mode include:

- Additional torque is requested for faster acceleration
- Hood is opened
- Hybrid battery charge is low and requires recharging
- Gear selector is moved to Manual
- Climate control system requires engine operation to generate heat



DC Voltage Classifications

The GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles use higher voltage than other Hybrids you may have encountered - they **MUST** be approached with caution.



DC/AC Voltage Classifications

GM has categorized voltage levels as either low, intermediate, or high voltage.

- **Low voltage** – from 0 to 30 volts DC / 0 to 15 volts AC
- **Intermediate voltage** – from 30 volts or greater to 60 volts DC / 15 volts or greater to 30 volts AC
- **High voltage** – any voltage greater than 60 volts DC / 30 volts AC

Classification	Low Voltage	Intermediate Voltage	High Voltage
Voltage Ranges	DC $\leq$ 30v — AC $\leq$ 15v	DC $>$ 30 $\leq$ 60v — AC $>$ 15 $\leq$ 30v RMS	DC $>$ 60v — AC $>$ 30v RMS
Two-mode Hybrid	Vehicle Accessory System	42v Electric Power Steering System	120v AC APO 300v DC and AC Hybrid System
* 42v DC Power Steering System ** 120v AC Accessory Power Outlets (APO)			

Note: Presently there are no industry standards to identify intermediate voltage. GM has chosen the color **BLUE** for this cable color.

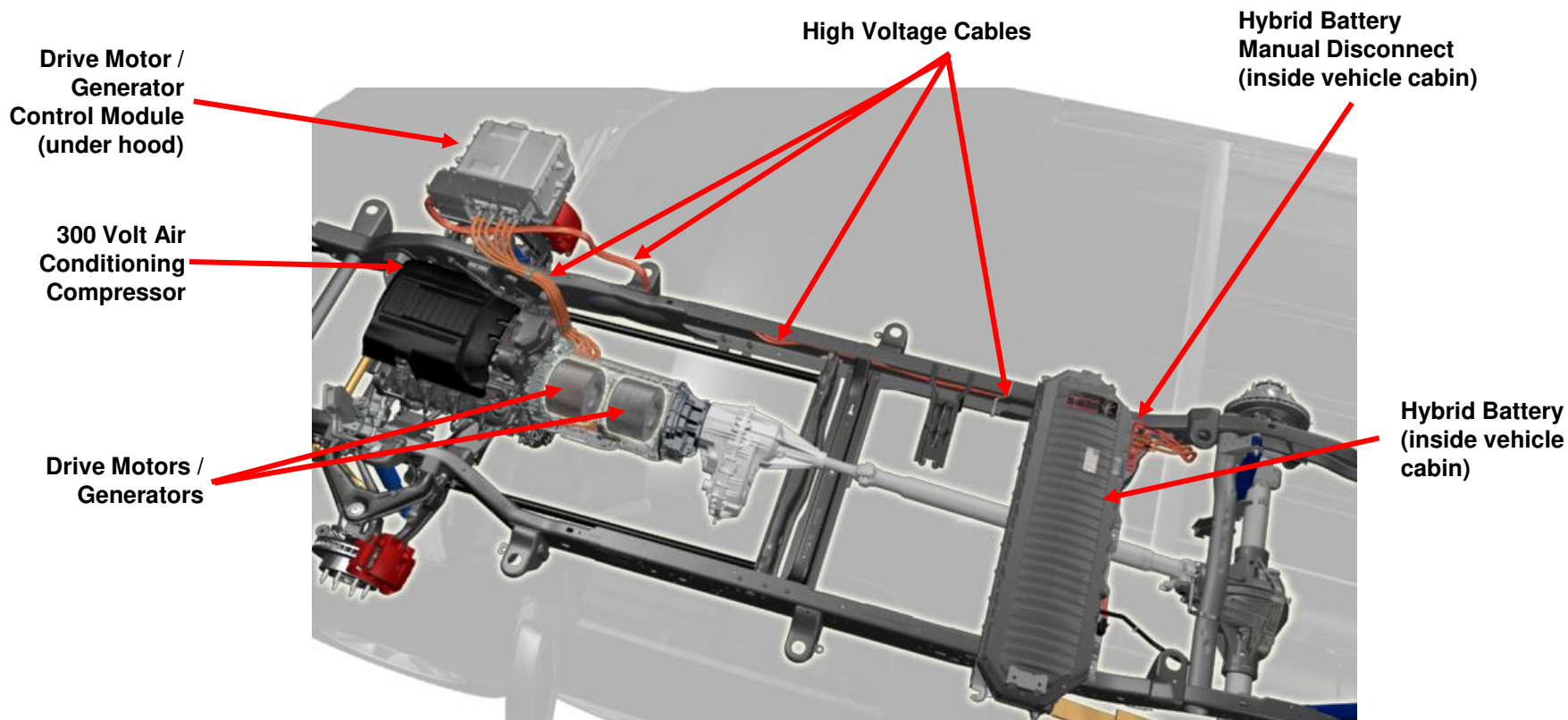
Color coding is used to identify the different levels – blue for intermediate voltage cables and orange for high voltage cables.

The GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles fall within both the Intermediate and the high voltage range.

Two-mode Hybrids utilize 300v (both AC and DC) for Hybrid System operation. A 120v AC Accessory Power Outlet (APO) is provided at the left, rear corner of the cargo area. Also, a 42v system supplies the Electric Power Steering (EPS) System.

Key Hybrid Components

This illustration shows the location of the key GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicle components.



Key Hybrid Components (cont.)



Conventional Engine with an Electronically Variable Transmission (EVT)

The GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid Vehicles use a conventional internal combustion engine coupled with an Electronically Variable Transmission (EVT) that includes two 60 Kilowatt electric motors to efficiently power the vehicle.

Note: All high voltage cables used in Two-mode Hybrid models are colored orange for easy identification.

Key Hybrid Components (cont.)

The Electronically Variable Transmission (EVT) contains two 60 Kilowatt motors / generators that are utilized to:

- Propel the vehicle
- Generate / recapture energy
- Start the Internal Combustion Engine (ICE)



Motors / Generators

Key Hybrid Components (cont.)

The Drive Motor / Generator Control Module performs the following operations:

- Inverts 300 volts DC to AC for vehicle propulsion
- Inverts 300 volts AC to DC for Hybrid battery recharging
- Provides 300 volts to Air Conditioning Compressor
- Converts 300 volts DC to 42 volts DC for the Electronic Power Steering (EPS) system operation
- Converts 300 volts DC to 12 volts DC for conventional 12 volt accessory operation

Note: Orange wiring is used to indicate high voltage. Blue wiring is used to indicate intermediate voltage.



Key Hybrid Components (cont.)

A Nickel Metal Hydride (NiMH) 300 volt Hybrid battery is enclosed in a metal case located under the second row, rear seat sub-floor. This 300V Hybrid battery supplies and stores energy for the vehicle and is also equipped with a manual disconnect.



**300V Hybrid Battery
Manual Disconnect**

Key Hybrid Components (cont.)

A hood ajar switch is part of the hood latch and prevents Auto Stop Mode from occurring if the hood of the vehicle is open.

If the hood is opened while the vehicle is in Auto Stop Mode, the engine will restart.

Note: The hood ajar switch will NOT prevent current flow through the 300 volt electrical system.



Approaching a Two-mode vehicle in Auto Stop Mode:

If you approach a Two-mode Hybrid vehicle operating in Auto Stop Mode, it may appear the vehicle is turned OFF, or the engine has stalled. Auto Stop Mode occurs under many conditions, including when the vehicle is in Park, Neutral or Drive and may last for several minutes. While in Auto Stop Mode the engine may restart without warning. Any of the following conditions will cause the engine to restart if the vehicle is in Auto Stop Mode:

- The hood is opened
- The shift lever is moved to Manual or Reverse
- The 300V Battery charge becomes too low
- Engine temperature drops too low



Approaching a Two-mode vehicle in Electric Vehicle (EV) Mode:

While operating in Auto Stop Mode, the Two-Mode Hybrid is also capable of propelling the vehicle electrically. Referred to as Electric Vehicle (EV) Mode, this mode allows the vehicle to be propelled at speeds up to 25 mph, (40 Kp/h) while the engine is not running. Without depression of the accelerator pedal, just enough energy is provided by the electric motors to allow the vehicle to creep slowly forward when in Drive. This operation is similar to a Non-Hybrid vehicle that has an idling engine. Depressing the accelerator pedal allows the vehicle to propel forward, and depending on pedal depression, could also result in the starting of the engine.

Perform the disabling 12V power procedure to ensure that all vehicle propulsion modes have been disabled.



Air Bag Deployment

The contactors inside the Hybrid battery are designed to open if one or more air bags deploy. This causes an interruption of the 300 volt electrical system and discontinues current flow in the high voltage cables.

This vehicle may have dual-stage airbags and the appearance of deployed airbags does not ensure that all parts of the airbags have deployed.

Therefore, disabling 12 volt power is essential to ensure personal safety even if the airbags in the vehicle appear to have been deployed. After disabling 12V power, wait at least 10 seconds to allow any un-deployed air bag reserve energy to dissipate.



To disable 12V power you must:



1. Turn the ignition key to the OFF position.

- And -

2. Remove the 12 volt (+) positive battery cable from the battery post. Ensure the terminal cannot contact the battery post.

Important: If the ignition key is NOT accessible:

- A. Disconnect the 12 volt positive (+) battery cable (located in the left, front underhood area).

- And -

- B. Cut all three exposed 12V positive cables. The cables are identified by the yellow First Responder labels.

B. Cut here



Note: The 12 volt battery cables have lever type, quick release terminals.

Note: After disabling 12V power, wait at least 10 seconds to allow any un-deployed air bag reserve energy to dissipate.

First Responder Labels

GM has implemented the labels shown here to help First Responders safely disable the vehicle in an emergency situation.



High Voltage Manual Disconnect

If accessible, you can minimize the potential for 300V current flow by removing the manual disconnect lever from the 300 volt Hybrid battery. The hybrid battery is located under the second row, rear seat sub-floor.

DANGER: The manual disconnect lever is designed to facilitate servicing of the vehicle. The energy potential within the 300V battery cannot be disabled. Even with the disconnect removed, assume the high voltage cables and components contain high voltage. If the 300 volt battery is exposed, it should only be handled by a properly trained technician - Otherwise, serious injury or death may occur.



High Voltage Cables - DO NOT CUT ZONES



DANGER: Do NOT cut the orange high voltage 300 volt cables. Cutting these cables can result in serious injury or death. No matter what disable method you have performed, always assume the high voltage cables and components contain high voltage.

Performing the “Disabling 12 Volt Power” procedure on the previous pages, will eliminate current flow through the 12 volt system and should also disable the high voltage electrical system, external to the 300V battery. No further action is required.

Vehicle DO NOT CUT ZONES

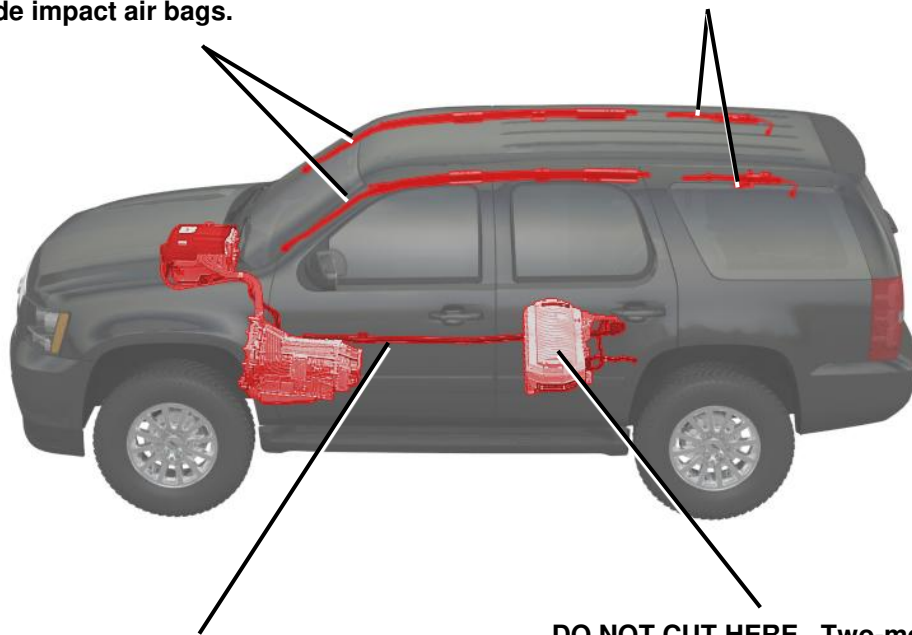
Do NOT cut the:

- Area near the passenger side frame rail. High voltage 300 volt wiring is routed near the frame rail on the passenger side of the vehicle.
- Roof rails between the windshield and 'D' pillars (rear pillars). GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles are equipped with side impact air bags.
- Two-mode Hybrid battery. The Two-mode Hybrid battery has 300 volt electrical potential at all times.

WARNING: Do NOT cut into the vehicle until the 12V electrical system has been deactivated. Cutting into the vehicle prior to disconnecting and isolating the 12V electrical energy sources may cause air bag deployment resulting in serious injury.

DO NOT CUT HERE. Roof rails between the windshield and 'D' pillars (rear pillars). Side impact air bags.

DO NOT CUT HERE. Side curtain air bags (with optional third row seat)



DO NOT CUT HERE. Under vehicle area near passenger side frame rail contains high voltage 300 volt electrical cables.

DO NOT CUT HERE. Two-mode Hybrid battery has 300 volt electrical potential at all times.

Do Not Cut Zones for SUV



Do Not Cut Zones for Pickup



Neutralizing a Battery Leak

The Nickel Metal Hydride (NiMH) battery contains Potassium Hydroxide and if a leak is detected, a mixture of Borax™ and water, or a Class D fire extinguisher should be used to neutralize the spill.

Refer to your MSDS sheet for more information.

POTASSIUM HYDROXIDE			0357 October 2000
CAS No: 1310-58-3 RTECS No: TT2100000 UN No: 1813 EC No: 019-002-00-6		Caustic potash Potassium hydrate Potassium lye KOH Molecular mass: 56.1	
TYPES OF HAZARD/EXPOSURE	ACUTE HAZARDS/SYMPTOMS	PREVENTION	FIRST AID/FIRE FIGHTING
FIRE	Not combustible. Contact with moisture or water may generate sufficient heat to ignite combustible materials.		In case of fire in the surroundings: all extinguishing agents allowed.
EXPLOSION			
EXPOSURE		AVOID ALL CONTACT!	IN ALL CASES CONSULT A DOCTOR!
Inhalation	Corrosive. Burning sensation. Sore throat. Cough. Labourous breathing. Shortness of breath. Symptoms may be delayed (see Notes).	Local exhaust or breathing protection.	Fresh air, rest, half-upright position. Artificial respiration if indicated. Refer for medical attention.
Skin	Corrosive. Redness. Pain. Blisters. Serious skin burns.	Protective gloves. Protective clothing.	Remove contaminated clothes. Rinse skin with plenty of water or shower. Refer for medical attention.
Eyes	Corrosive. Redness. Pain. Blurred vision. Severe deep burns.	Face shield, or eye protection in combination with breathing protection if powder.	First rinse with plenty of water for several minutes (remove contact lenses if easily possible), then take to a doctor.
Ingestion	Corrosive. Abdominal pain. Burning sensation. Shock or collapse.	Do not eat, drink, or smoke during work.	Rinse mouth. Do NOT induce vomiting. Give plenty of water to drink. Refer for medical attention.
SPILLAGE DISPOSAL		PACKAGING & LABELLING	
Sweep spilled substance into suitable containers. Wash away remainder with plenty of water. (Extra personal protection: complete protective clothing including self-contained breathing apparatus).		C Symbol R: 22-35 S: (112+125-35/37/39-45 UN Hazard Class: 8 UN Pack Group: II	
EMERGENCY RESPONSE		STORAGE	
Transport Emergency Card: TEC (R)-123 NFPA Code: H 3, F 2, R 1		Separated from strong acids, metals, food and feedstuffs. Dry. Well closed. Store in an area having corrosion resistant concrete floor.	
 Prepared in the context of cooperation between the International Programme on Chemical Safety and the European Commission © IPCS 2000 SEE IMPORTANT INFORMATION ON THE BACK.			

Conclusion

We are serious about making your job as safe as possible.

As you have seen, certain differences exist between the GMC Yukon and Sierra, Chevrolet Tahoe and Silverado, and Cadillac Escalade Two-mode Hybrid vehicles and conventional vehicles. These differences require forethought when approaching an emergency situation concerning these Two-mode Hybrid vehicles.

We are confident the information contained in this guide will prove useful as you prepare to assist those involved in an emergency event.

For information regarding modification of GM's First Responder Information for other uses, contact GM's Licensing Manager at:

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Attn: Licensing Coordinator

